
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Middle Age Pyrène

Time of the Akelarre

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Unmodded 6.36 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Middle Age Pyrène: Time of the Akelarre

Pyrène one-page command brief

Pyrène combines unusually resilient human troops with mobile Air-Blood witches, blood-sacrificing priests, forest-recruitable Akerbeltz, cave recruits, and a capital sacred cavalry arm. The nation is not merely "Blood with knights." Its real advantage is distributed recruitment. Forests, caves, mountains, and ordinary forts can each add a different part of the state.

The opening should convert that geography into capacity:

- forts recruit the ordinary army, Sorginak, and Bishops;
- non-fort forests can recruit Akerbeltz;
- non-fort provinces can recruit path-random Pyrènian Monks;
- non-fort caves and the capital can recruit Bekryde scouts, leaders, and troops;
- the capital produces Emerald Knights and Emerald Counts;
- Blood and Nature then turn population, slaves, and terrain access into a growing magical economy.

The nation has clear weaknesses. Most human troops and leaders have Magic Resistance 9. The best sacred cavalry is capital-only and extremely resource intensive. Crossbows have Precision 8. Akerbeltz are expensive four-point commanders. Native Astral, Death, Water, and Glamour are absent. Air begins at A2, which is useful but does not by itself cast every famous Air spell or the national A3 ritual.

Pyrène evidence and ruleset

The official revision-2 manual supplies the roster, national summary, and Send Aatxe. The pinned 6.35 Inspector export resolves randoms:

- Pyrènian Bishop: B1 H2 plus one guaranteed Fire, Earth, or Blood level;
- Pyrènian Monk: H1 plus one guaranteed Fire, Earth, Nature, or Blood level;
- Sorgina: fixed F1 A2 B2;
- Akerbeltz: E1 N2 B3, one guaranteed Earth, Nature, or Blood level, plus an independent 10% second roll from the same set.

These are unmodded records. Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus must be treated as separate rosters.

Pyrène conversion chain

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resistant infantry, crossbows, and cavalry
-> forests and caves secured during expansion
-> distributed commanders and blood hunters
-> Akerbeltz crossbreeding and Nature-Earth support
-> Sorgina Air-Blood battlefield groups
-> slave economy, blood rituals, and remote pressure
-> mobile sacred and supernatural armies
```

Pyrène can own many commanders while still lacking the right package. Distributed recruitment only becomes an advantage when every location has a declared job and the roads, laboratories, and blood-slave routes connect them.

National body and terrain rules

The ordinary Pyrènian and Bekryde roster has partial resistance to Fire and Cold, darkvision, and broad Mountain Survival. Those traits matter most when the nation deliberately chooses terrain and opponents that make them relevant. Five points of resistance softens common elemental damage; it is not immunity to concentrated battlefield magic.

Geographic asset	What it can produce	Strategic use
Forest without a fort	Akerbeltz	Expensive high Blood-Nature-Earth mage production outside the normal fort queue
Cave without a fort	Bekryde troops, scout, and leader	Cheap local bodies, information, and mountain-capable reinforcement
Any suitable non-fort province	Pyrènian Monk	Distributed H1 and one random path from F/E/N/B
Capital	Emerald sacred cavalry and Akerbeltz	Sacred shock force and the most reliable elite mage point
Ordinary fort	Main human army, Sorgina, Bishop	Repeatable military and magic core

The extra Turmoil design limit is permission, not a command. Blood hunting, expensive commanders, forts, and knights still depend on population and gold. A high-Turmoil design needs a clear compensating engine rather than assuming national flavour makes lost income harmless.

Pyrène roster by job

Unit	Best job	Important limit
Bekryde and Bekryde Warrior	Cheap cave and mountain-capable line or siege mass	Low MR and light armour; local availability controls scale
Pyrènian Crossbowman	Armour pressure behind a screen	Precision 8 and ordinary protection
Pyrènian Spearman	Shielded line and general frontage	Ordinary damage and MR 9
Pyrènian Footman	Higher-Defence shielded line	Armour and Encumbrance can become a fatigue problem
Pyrènian Swordsman	High-damage heavy infantry	No shield and modest Defence
Pyrènian Man at Arms	Better-quality line	Higher gold, resources, and recruitment points
Pyrènian Knight	Mobile shock and reserve	Expensive and still MR 9 on the rider
Emerald Knight	Capital sacred cavalry	Seventy gold, forty resources, thirty-one recruitment points, and capital competition

The sacred mouflon is a separate component with strong armour, Mountain Survival, and Cold Resistance. Its low Magic Resistance remains relevant against effects that can target the mount. Book IV's mounted rules should be applied to both rider and animal.

Pyrène commander and mage portfolio

Commander	Paths or ability	Main jobs	Recruitment warning
Pyrènian Bishop	B1 H2 + F/E/B random	Blood sacrifice, hunting, priest support, low-path magic	Two recruitment points; record random immediately

Commander	Paths or ability	Main jobs	Recruitment warning
Sorgina	F1 A2 B2, flying, Storm Immune	Blood hunting, Air and Fire battle magic, mobile reinforcement	Costs 260 gold; mass recruitment can consume the whole research and fort budget
Akerbeltz	E1 N2 B3 + E/N/B random, Blood Searcher 1, Cross Breeder +4	Blood economy, Cross Breeding, Nature-Earth support, searching	450 gold, four recruitment points; forests need protection and logistics
Pyrenian Monk	H1 + F/E/N/B random, non-fort recruitment	Distributed research, searching, rituals, preaching	Slow recruitment and modest research efficiency; use the roll rather than collecting them without purpose
Emerald Count	Sacred H1 cavalry leader	Sacred command and mobile priest support	Capital-only, two recruitment points
Castellan, Marquess, Bekryde Champion	Mundane leadership	Main army, cavalry, and cave command	Pick leadership for the actual force instead of paying for unused armour or mobility

Random-path consequences

A guaranteed one-in-three Bishop random creates F1B1H2, E1B1H2, or B2H2. This gives every ordinary fort a predictable portfolio after several recruits, but it does not guarantee the required result on the first month.

The Monk's one-in-four random is valuable because recruitment is geographically distributed. F1, E1, N1, and B1 results cover searching and minor rituals without using a fort. The trade is speed: a province producing a Monk is not producing another special commander that month, and the mage still needs a laboratory for most magic work.

The Akerbeltz guaranteed random produces E2, N3, or B4 before the 10% roll is considered. Each result changes its best job:

- E2 can use Summon Earthpower to reach higher battlefield Earth thresholds;
- N3 opens stronger Nature support and searching;
- B4 accelerates high Blood rituals;
- the rare second roll may deepen or mix these roles, but no opening should require it.

Blood economy without self-destruction

Pyrene has unusually broad access to hunters: Sorginak are B2, Bishops are at least B1, and Akerbeltz are B3 with Blood Searcher 1. That does not mean every mage should hunt.

A working blood province needs:

- enough population to survive the intended hunting period;
- hunters whose slave return exceeds their lost research or battle work;
- unrest control and patrollers;
- a laboratory or a reliable slave-transfer route;
- protection against raids and assassins;
- a declared use for the slaves.

Akerbeltz are excellent hunters but expensive researchers, ritualists, searchers, and crossbreeders. Using every one as a hunter can waste the very path breadth that makes them special. Bishops and Sorginak often provide the scalable hunting layer while selected Akerbeltz handle the difficult Blood, Nature, or Earth jobs.

Blood sacrifice should be budgeted separately. Slaves spent on dominion are not available for rituals or battle. The sacrifice is worthwhile when it changes a real dominion contest, sacred operation, or victory condition.

Pyrène opening priorities

- 1 Test the local independent types against shielded infantry, crossbows, knights, or the Pretender.
- 2 Identify every reachable forest and cave before deciding the first fort route.
- 3 Recruit enough Sorginak and Bishops to start research and a controlled blood economy.
- 4 Use forests for Akerbeltz only when the province can be defended and connected.
- 5 Keep capital resources from being consumed by Emerald Knights when infrastructure is the actual bottleneck.

Expansion packages to test

Package	Intended target	Failure signal
Shielded foot plus crossbows	Ordinary infantry and armour	Precision and friendly fire erase the value of the ranged line
Heavy foot	Low-damage opponents	Fatigue, armour-piercing weapons, or magic overwhelms protection
Pyrènian Knights	Weak lines and exposed ranged troops	Anti-large weapons or MR attacks trade too efficiently
Emerald Knights	Important high-value provinces	Capital production and resources fall behind the economic timetable
Awake Pretender	Difficult early targets and fast terrain capture	The design duplicates jobs the national roster already performs

Pyrène research response tree

Trunk: establish Blood and practical equipment

Blood 1
-> Blood 3
-> Construction 2 or 4

Early Blood research should lead to a named slave use. Blood 3 is especially important for Cross Breeding, because Akerbeltz carry Adept Cross Breeder +4. Construction opens tools for hunters, commanders, and battlefield specialists. The exact order changes when war demands an immediate Air, Earth, or Nature spell.

Branch A: Sorgina battlefield magic

Evocation 2 and later Air research gives the fixed A2 Sorgina a repeatable damage role. A2 is not A3. Storm, the national Send Aatxe ritual, and several famous Air breakpoints require a real route to A3 or higher. A Pretender, hero, empowerment, booster chain, or later summon must own that bridge. Storm Power can raise a mage during an existing storm; it does not solve who created the first storm.

Branch B: Akerbeltz Earth and Nature

Conjuration 3 lets E2 Akerbeltz use Summon Earthpower and makes several elemental routes practical. Alteration and Enchantment then provide protection, armour reduction, regeneration, poison, or control according to the actual random and target. Do not research N3 or E3 packages until the matching random has been recorded or a reliable bridge exists.

Branch C: blood battlefield and ritual pressure

Blood research should be advanced in steps attached to a current army or strategic ritual, not rushed as one uninterrupted school. The nation can support Sabbath structures through Blood, but Book V's communion correction ledger applies: master throughput, slave paths, gem use, and collapse must be budgeted. A large slave stock is not permission to use an untested communion.

Branch D: Send Aatxe

The national ritual is Conjuration 6, A3, costs six Air gems, has range four, is anonymous, and cannot be cast underwater. Native Sorginak stop at A2. The research target therefore becomes real only after the A3 caster route is written down. If that route exists, the ritual gives Pyrène a cheap remote pressure tool; if it does not, Conjuration 6 alone delivers nothing.

Pyrène battlefield packages

Resistant human line

Pyrènian infantry can absorb modest Fire and Cold better than ordinary humans. Add shields, spacing, and the right troop type before adding magic. The resistance is a margin that makes some trades favourable, not a reason to stand inside full battlefield elemental damage.

Sorgina strike group

Flying, Storm-Immune F1 A2 B2 mages can reposition rapidly and join selected battles. Their scripts should use reachable A2, F1, or Blood effects and preserve a retreat route. Flying mobility does not protect a 10-HP human body from arrows, assassins, or a collapsed screen.

Akerbeltz crossbreeding economy

Cross Breeding converts Blood slaves and an Akerbeltz turn into variable bodies. The +4 national specialist bonus makes Pyrène unusually suited to the system, but the output remains a portfolio rather than a guaranteed army type. Record batches, costs, useful results, leadership burden, and attrition before assigning a fixed strategic value.

Sacred mouflon force

Emerald Knights offer protection, mobility, Mountain Survival, and a sacred mount. They are scarce enough that the bless should improve survival and role reliability. The package still needs magic resistance, fatigue control, and answers to anti-large weapons. A sacred cavalry army that cannot replace losses is a finite resource.

Pyrène Pretender families

Family	What it solves	What it must not conceal
Air bridge	A3+ for Storm, Send Aatxe, stronger Air, and battlefield transitions	The caster still needs research, gems, safety, and timing
Astral or Death import	Missing strategic paths, resistance magic, summons, and communions	Imported access may remain tied to one irreplaceable god
Scales and blood economy	Gold, forts, laboratories, population, and recovery from hunting	Turmoil or Death choices can undermine the population base
Moderate cavalry bless	Emerald Knights and mounts	Sacred production is capital and resource limited
Awake expander	Rapid forests, caves, and chokepoints	National infantry and knights may already handle ordinary expansion

The most valuable design often solves a missing system rather than adding more Fire, Nature, or Blood to paths already available. Air, Astral, Death, Water, or a specific global route can change the whole national tree.

Pyrène matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
High-MR attacks against troops	Bufs, screening, summons, imported Astral, shorter exposure	Assuming armour protects MR 9 infantry
Fire or Cold warfare	National resistance plus additional buffs and spacing	Treating resistance 5 as immunity
Heavy armour	Crossbows, great swords, Earth armour reduction, Blood or summoned alternatives	Relying on low-Precision crossbows without enough volume and protection
Fast raiders	Flying Sorgina reserve, cave and forest scouts, local commanders	Leaving blood provinces and forest mages undefended
Battlefield-wide Air	Storm immunity on Sorginak, shock resistance plans, dispersed command	Extending a mage's immunity to the whole army
Population pressure	Rotate hunting, control unrest, move the blood centre	Continuing to hunt a province after its long-term value collapses

Monthly Pyrène audit

- Which forests and caves are producing something that no ordinary fort can?
- Are blood hunters separated from battle mages and researchers?
- What are the current slave income, stock, and committed uses?
- Are Bishop, Monk, and Akerbeltz randoms recorded?
- Does the active research target have a real caster?
- Who reaches A3 for Storm or Send Aatxe?
- Is the sacred cavalry queue delaying forts or mages?
- Are MR 9 troops being sent into a counter they cannot armour through?
- Can every distributed recruitment province be reinforced or evacuated?

Pyrène verification ledger

The next useful tests are:

- 1 expansion ranges for shielded foot, crossbows, Pyrènian Knights, and Emerald Knights;
- 2 current live confirmation of Bishop, Monk, and Akerbeltz random displays;
- 3 Blood Searcher 1 returns across population and unrest bands;
- 4 Cross Breeder +4 outcome records across a versioned sample;
- 5 Air transition packages before and after a real A3 bridge;
- 6 sacred rider and mouflon survival under MR and anti-large attacks;
- 7 distributed-recruitment payback from forests and caves;
- 8 DE and Divinitus variants kept separate from this unmodded dossier.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: MA Marignon and MA Pyrène nation pages, national spells and rituals, research, communions, Blood, Inquisition, mounts, and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.36, including the current Send Aatxe restriction and communion corrections.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks and current object cross-checks.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, and crossbreeding outputs remain test questions until a versioned raw set is published.